number would have remained consistent with 2010 had a second round of cancellations not occurred on 27 October. In Kachin State, the number of partial cancellations increased from 2010, however, this did not directly lead to increased disenfranchisement, as will be explained below.

The cancellations must be understood in their respective geographical and political contexts, but with few exceptions they have one element in common — the absence of the state. In most situations where elections were cancelled, a voter list had never been established. Creating the voter list requires data from local offices, namely the Department of Immigration and Population at township level, and offices of the General Administration Department (GAD) at ward and village tract level.[10] In addition, the GAD fulfils electoral functions on the lower levels of the administration. Thus, if there is no GAD at the local level, there is no voter list and no office to organize elections in that area.

Therefore, the partial election cancellations seem to equate to the absence of the state's administrative capacity in most cases. This is particularly evident in the areas under the control of the KIO in Kachin State; in those parts of Hpapun township under control of Karen National Liberation Army (KNLA) Brigade 5 in Kayin State; in territories controlled by the United Wa State Army (UWSA) in the Wa Self-Administered Division (SAD), and by the National Democratic Alliance Army (NDAA) in Mongla township in Shan State, formerly termed Special Regions 2 and 4. Only a few of the cancellations declared on 12 October concerned areas assessed as having the potential for actual violence on election day, or that saw physical disruptions to earlier phases of the electoral cycle, such as the voter list display. These exceptional cases included the conflict-ridden township of Mansi in southern Kachin State, and Kawkareik township in Kayin State, where tensions between the state security apparatus and several EAGs caused insecurity along the Asia Highway during the voter list update period.

The cancellations have different administrative consequences, depending on the size of the administrative units concerned. Vacant seats occur only where elections are cancelled for an entire constituency; this was the case for seven townships in Shan State, resulting in seven vacant seats in the Pyithu Hluttaw and fourteen vacant seats in the Shan State Hluttaw (the Amyotha Hluttaw is not affected). Contra to this, the cancellation of elections in specific wards and village tracts smaller than a constituency do not translate into vacant seats in the legislature, leading to the disenfranchisement of voters as the election goes ahead regardless of their involvement, as well